

The Best Places to Eat Feijoada

A Casa da Feijoada moderate

This traditional restaurant, just a stroll away from the beach in Ipanema, has been serving *feijoada* to local families for decades. It's best to come with a very empty stomach for a full feast, which begins with a little bowl of rose coco (borlotti) bean soup. This is followed by a steaming tureen of *feijoada* (with extra bowls of meat so relentless carnivores can add to the stew at whim), and traditional accompaniments of spring greens pan-fried in garlic, fried manioc, rice, *farofa* (toasted manioc flour), and slices of succulent orange. Portions are large enough for two. Unlike most Rio restaurants, this one serves *feijoada* every day. Crowds get large on a Sunday, so be sure to make reservations.

Prudente de Moraes 10, Ipanema, Rio de Janeiro; open noon–11 PM daily; +55 21 2247 2776

Also in Rio

The Casa da Feijoada vies with another fashionable alfresco restaurant and bar in nearby chic Leblon — **Academia da Cachaça** (+55 21 2529 2680; *expensive*). Like its rival, the Academia serves a traditional *feijoada* daily (with smaller portions for kids on request). A meal here wouldn't be complete without a glass or two of fine Minas Gerais *cachaça* rum, from the most extensive *cachaça* menu in Rio.

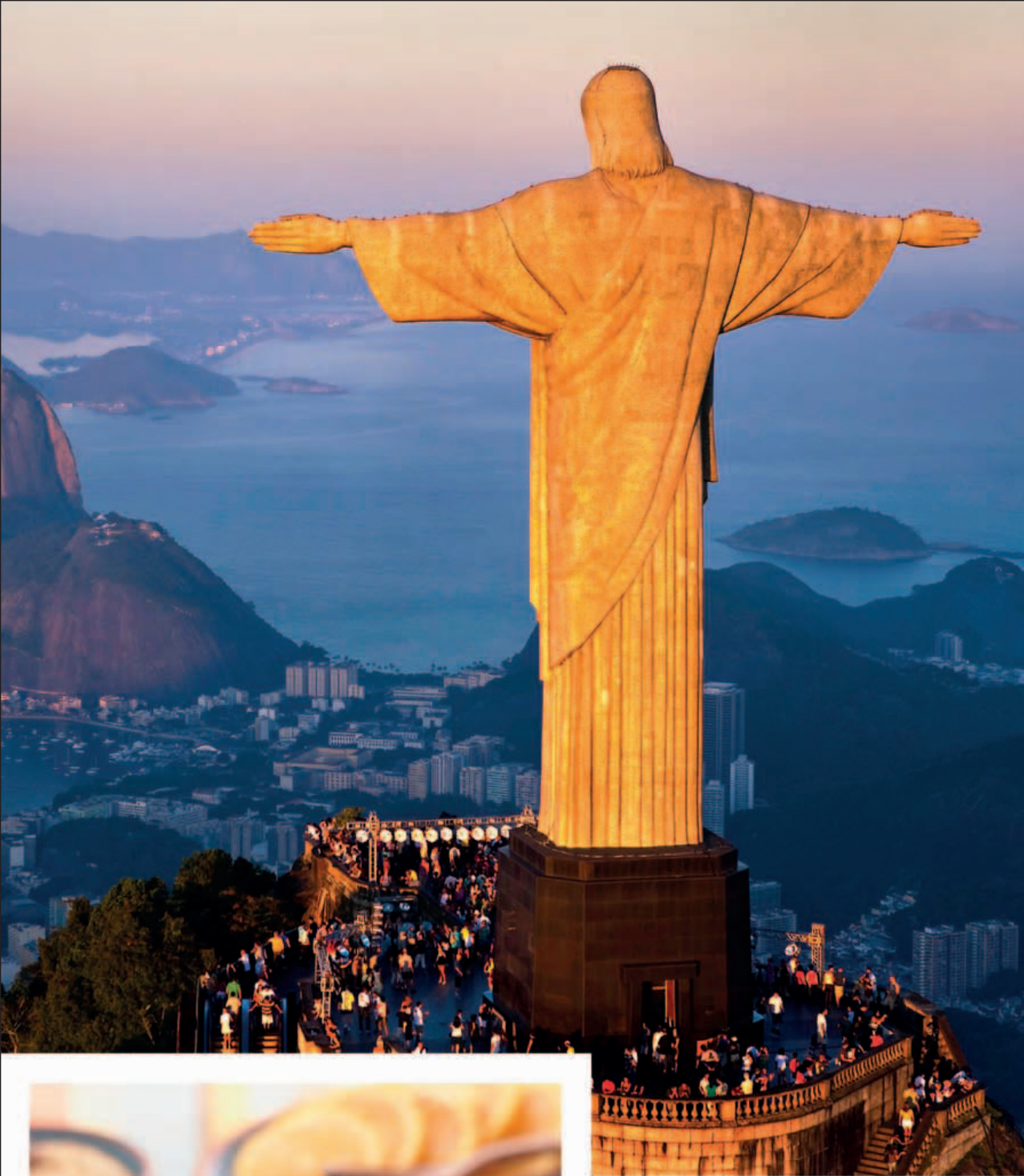
Also in Brazil

In a poll conducted by São Paulo's prestigious *Folha* newspaper, **Veloso** (+55 11 5572 0254; *moderate*) was voted the best place in the city for *feijoada*. The lively bar and restaurant serves the classic stew with traditional trimmings. Drink it with a caipirinha cocktail (*cachaça* and plenty of lime) — barman Souza is said to serve one of the best in Brazil.

Around the World

The uber-trendy, arty Shoreditch bar and restaurant **Favela Chic** (www.favelachic.com; *moderate*) in London was inspired by the colorful bric-a-brac of a Rio *favela* slum and is famed for its exuberant atmosphere. Its daytime menu includes *feijoada* and the bar serves caipirinha cocktails, *cachaça* rum, and Portuguese Sagres beer. There's a branch of the restaurant in Paris too.

New Yorkers dine on a varied menu of Brazilian favorites at **Ipanema** (www.ipanemany.com; *moderate*), a mid–West Side restaurant in the heart of a cluster of streets that have become known collectively as “Little Brazil.” Prices are great for Manhattan, and the choice includes a huge *feijoada* big enough for at least two people.



Above Rio's Ipanema beach stretches for 2 miles (3 km); two mountains, the Dois Irmãos (“two brothers”), mark its western end

Left Traditionally made using pork offcuts, *feijoada* can encompass a range of different meats, from pork *choriço* to salted, cured beef